



IN THE GALLERY

In this early 1900s drawing of the Globe, fashionable audience members are watching a performance of *Henry IV* from the lowest gallery.

The audience

PLAYGOING BECAME THE most popular form of entertainment for Londoners in the late-16th century. As many as 3,000 people would gather to watch any one performance. Playhouses drew their audiences from all walks of life. Farmers, seamstresses, soldiers, sailors, apprentices, and servants stood side by side in the

crowded yard. Foreign tourists, lawyers, and merchants filled the gallery seats, and wealthy nobles sat in the gentlemen's rooms next to the stage, so that they could show off their expensive clothes.

SHAKESPEARIAN SNACKS

Apples and pears were for sale as snacks in the playhouses in Shakespeare's time. Different varieties were available at different times. The first apples to ripen were called "Juneaters" because they were ready for eating on June 29 – St. John's Day. Another variety was called the John apple because it kept well and could be stored until the following St. John's Day.



Williams pears



Pippins, grown in orchards in Kent, were the most common variety of apple

Pippin apples



Apples were bought as gifts for noblewomen



CARPET OF NUTS

In 1988 and 1989, archaeologists found that the yards of the Rose and Globe had been covered with hazelnut shells. The shells had been mixed with ash and used as a floor covering to keep the yards dry in wet weather. Some may have been dropped by the audience, because nuts were a popular snack.

BUSINESS AND PLEASURE

Female fruit sellers called apple wives loved the large audiences they found at layhouses like the Globe. The apple wives wandered around the yard and the galleries carrying baskets of apples and pears. They had no trouble finding hungry customers to buy their fruit, and they could enjoy the play as they worked.

The apple wives found it hard to make a living if the playhouses were closed

